

⚠ Please do not reach out to reviewers directly; messaging them will not speed up your review.

Defending Your Submission

How to respond to review feedback and appeal decisions.

Responding to Feedback

Read Carefully

Before responding:

1. Read each comment fully
2. Understand what's being asked
3. Consider if the feedback is valid
4. Check if you missed something

Acknowledge Valid Points

If the reviewer is right:

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"You're right, the test on line 45 uses brittle string matching.
I've updated it to check for the presence of required fields instead."

Explain Your Reasoning

If you disagree or need clarification:

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```
"I chose to use exact string matching here because the output format is strictly specified in the instructions (line 12). The agent is to output exactly 'status: success' – would checking for 'success' alone be acceptable, or should I clarify the instructions?"
```

Ask Questions

If feedback is unclear:

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```
"Could you clarify what you mean by 'tests are too strict'?  
Are you referring to the format checking or the value validation?"
```

Making Changes

Be Thorough

Address every point raised, not just some.

Be Explicit

When you push changes, explain what you did:

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```
Addressed review feedback:  
- Line 45: Changed string match to field check  
- Line 67: Added docstring to test_output  
- instruction.md: Clarified output format requirement
```

Don't Over-Engineer

Fix what's asked. Don't rewrite unrelated code.

Disagreements

When to Push Back

It's okay to disagree if:

- You have a valid technical reason
- The feedback misunderstands your approach
- The requested change would break something

How to Push Back

Be respectful and provide evidence:

Don't:

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"That's wrong. My approach is fine."

Do:

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"I understand the concern about test brittleness, but in this case the exact format is critical – the task specifically requires JSON with these exact keys. Here's why I think the current test is appropriate: [explanation]. Would you like me to add a comment explaining this, or do you still think I should change it?"

Escalation

If you can't resolve disagreement with the reviewer:

1. **Document your position** clearly in the submission
2. **Reach out on Slack** to `#ec-terminus-submission`;

Snorkel make final decisions on disputes.

Appeals

When to Appeal

Appeal if:

- Task was declined but you believe it meets criteria
- Feedback is incorrect or unfair
- There's a misunderstanding about requirements

How to Appeal

1. **Reply to the decision** with your reasoning
2. **Provide specific evidence** for your position
3. **Be professional** - appeals are reviewed by seniors
4. **Accept the outcome** - final decisions are final

Appeal Template

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I'd like to appeal this decision. Here's my reasoning:

Reviewer said: [quote feedback]

My response: [your explanation]

Evidence: [specific examples, references, etc.]

I believe this task should be [accepted/reconsidered] because [reas

Tips for Smooth Reviews

Before Submission

- Run all checks locally

- Self-review against guidelines
- Have a colleague look at it

During Review

- Respond promptly (within 1-2 days)
- Be collaborative, not defensive
- Ask questions early

If Declined

- Take feedback seriously
- Consider if the task can be salvaged
- Learn from it for next time
- It's okay to start fresh

Remember

Reviewers are on your side. They want tasks to succeed. Most feedback is meant to help you improve your submission, not reject it.

A collaborative attitude leads to faster acceptance.

PREVIOUS

[Common Errors](#)

NEXT

[Quality Guidelines](#)